Simon Foster

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Profile

Senior .NET Developer with 10+ years building and modernising business-critical web platforms in C#, ASP.NET, SQL Server, and Azure. Proven track record delivering microservice improvements, reducing cloud costs, and improving deployment reliability through CI/CD and DevOps practices. Seeking a senior backend/full-stack role where I can lead delivery and continuous improvement.

Key Skills

- Languages: C#, JavaScript, SQL
- Cloud: Azure, AWS
- DevOps: Azure DevOps, TeamCity, Git, CI/CD pipelines, Kubernetes, Grafana
- Databases: SQL Server, MS Access
- Web: ASP.Net MVC, REST APIs
- Other: Microservices, Agile, Unit/Integration Testing

AI

- GitHub Copilot: use in day-to-day development for code generation, refactoring, and review support (with human oversight).
- Semantic Kernel (C#): personal projects integrating OpenAI models; prompt engineering and orchestration.
- Pragmatic approach: treat LLM output as a draft; verify with tests and code review, and avoid sharing sensitive data.

Work

January 2023 – Present Software Developer at Optix Software

- Drive continuous improvement projects and cross-cutting initiatives across a microservices estate as part of the DevOps team.
- Enhanced backend services for Optix 2, enabling seamless payment processing and product/service sales for customers.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams to deliver high-quality, maintainable code.

October 2021 – November 2022 Senior Developer at BlueTree Group

- Maintained and improved www.instantprint.co.uk and internal systems/APIs within a microservice architecture.
- Contributed to agile development, code reviews, and knowledge sharing within the team.
- Ensured robust deployments and high code quality through collaboration with testers, project managers, and business stakeholders.

March 2020 – September 2021 Senior Developer at Tersus Consultancy (formerly Eurosafe UK)

- Built and maintained web applications for internal business processes, integrating IT systems post-acquisition.
- Exported legacy application data for third-party system integration.
- Maintained the SaaS product Ultimate Manager, authored unit/integration tests, and scheduled deployments.
- Reduced Azure costs by consolidating and migrating services.

July 2019 – March 2020 IT Consultant and Contract Developer working with Eurosafe UK

- Architected, built, and deployed solutions tailored to business needs using .Net Core, REST APIs, Azure, and Azure DevOps.
- Guided platform migrations and ensured alignment between requirements and deliverables.

June 2018 – June 2019 Software Engineer for Tunstall Healthcare

- Developed new features, fixed bugs, and collaborated with business owners and testers in an agile team.
- Led code review initiatives and contributed to API and Swagger documentation.
- Mentored graduate developers.

October 2016 – June 2018 Web Applications Developer for Counter Intelligence Retail (later NPD Travel Retail)

- Designed, developed, and released client websites.
- Introduced source control and continuous deployment pipelines with approval gates and code reviews.
- Modernized legacy webform applications to ASP.Net MVC.
- Automated data loading processes and migrated web applications to Azure PaaS with global redundancy.

June 2014 – October 2016 Developer/IT Manager for Eurosafe UK

- Project managed and collaborated with external teams to enhance a SaaS platform using Visual Studio, Azure, Git, and SQL Server.
- Developed internal line-of-business applications (SQL Server, MS Access VBA).
- Automated asbestos management processes and improved project diary reporting.
- Installed and maintained TeamCity build server for frequent, low-downtime updates.

January 2011 – June 2014 IT Manager for Eurosafe UK

October 2006 – January 2011 System Administrator for Eurosafe UK

May 2005 – October 2006 Customer Service Representative for Norwich Union

January 2005 – April 2005 Administrative Assistant for City of York Council

September 2004 – November 2004 Administrative Assistant for Pesticide Safety Directorate

November 2003 – September 2004 Administrative Assistant for Department for Environment Food and Rural Affairs (DEFRA)

Certifications

- AZ-900 Microsoft Azure Fundamentals
- AWS Cloud Practitioner

Education

1999 - 2003 MPhys (Hons) degree (2:2) in Experimental Physics University of York
1997 - 1999 Redhill Sixth Form Physics (A), Maths (A), Chemistry (C), Further Maths (D)
1992 - 1997 Redhill Comprehensive School GCSE 9 A* - D including Science, Mathematics and English